Jordan-Hölder theory for complementary polyhedra

Emanuel Roth, eroth2@ed.ac.uk, arxiv: 2609.17231

Algebra Geometry & Quantum Fields

Poster QR

THE UNIVERSITY of EDINBURGH

For a Noetherian, Artinian object A inside an Abelian category $\mathcal{A}$, there exists a **Jordan-Hölder (JH) filtration**: [SP, 0FCD]:

$$0 = A_0 \subset \cdots \subset A_l = A$$

whose quotients $B_i := (A_i/A_{i-1})$ are simple, and whose **associated graded** $\bigoplus_{i=0}^{l} B_i$ is unique. Seshadri applied this to **slope-semistable vector bundles over a smooth projective K-curve X**.

JH filtrations of vector bundles [Ses67, Proposition 3.1]

For a semistable vector bundle E over a compact Riemann surface X, there exists a JH filtration of subbundles:

$$0 = E_0 \subset \cdots \subset E_l = E$$

whose quotients $F_i := E_i/E_{i-1}$ are stable and have the same slope as E. Two JH filtrations have isomorphic associated gradeds $gr(E) := \bigoplus_{i=0}^{l} F_i$.

When $\mathrm{gr}(E) \cong \mathrm{gr}(F)$, $E \sim_S F$ are **S-equivalent**. For genus $g(X) \geq 2$, S-equivalence classes of semistable bundles have a **coarse moduli space** $M\mathrm{Bun}_{r,d}^{S-eq}$ [Ses67, Theorem 8.1.] that is a normal projective K-variety. This generalizes to **principal bundles** by Ramanathan in [Ram96, I. 3.12. Proposition and II. 5.9. Theorem].

Adding $char(K) = 0$, we have a **good moduli space** $\pi : \mathcal{M}Bun_{r,d}^{sst} \to M\mathrm{Bun}_{r,d}^{S-eq}$ sending E to its S-equivalence class represented by the polystable $\mathrm{gr}(E)$, following [Alp13, 13.]. Generally, there are good moduli spaces of **parahoric torsors** [AHH23, Theorem 8.1] and **parahoric Higgs torsors** [Rég25, Theorem 5.26.].

Behrend in **"Semi-stability of reductive group schemes"** [Beh95] determines **Harder-Narasimhan filtrations/canonical reductions** through **complementary polyhedra**. Faces of Weyl chambers in root systems Φ are called **facets** P, and fundamental weights in facets are **vertices** $\mathrm{vert}(P)$.

Complementary polyhedra [Beh95, Definition 2.1]

For a root system $\Phi \subset (V, \langle _, _ \rangle)$, a map $d : \mathfrak{W}_\Phi \to V^*$ from the Weyl chambers is a **complementary polyhedron** if:

(A1) $\forall \mathfrak{c}, \mathfrak{d} \in \mathfrak{W}_\Phi$ with a common vertex $\lambda \in \mathrm{vert}(\mathfrak{c}) \cap \mathrm{vert}(\mathfrak{d})$, we have $d(\mathfrak{c})(\lambda) = d(\mathfrak{d})(\lambda)$.

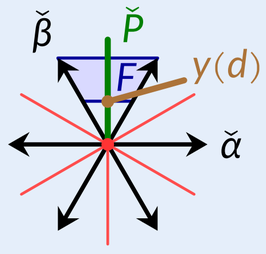
(A2) $\forall \mathfrak{c}, \mathfrak{d} \in \mathfrak{W}_\Phi$, and $\alpha \in \Phi$, such that $\mathfrak{c}$ is *α-conjugate* to $\mathfrak{d}$, i.e., $\mathfrak{c}$ is positive with respect to α, and $\mathfrak{d}$ is negative with respect to α, then $d(\mathfrak{c})(\alpha) \leq d(\mathfrak{d})(\alpha)$.

$F(P) := \mathrm{conv}\{d(\mathfrak{c}) \mid P \subset \overline{\mathfrak{c}}\}$ for a facet P, and $F := F(\{0\})$ is the *convex hull* of d.

For a principal G-bundle ξ, where G is reductive, the **automorphism group scheme** $\mathrm{Ad}(\xi)$ is reductive and is **rationally split**, i.e., splits over $\eta := \mathrm{Spec}(K(X))$. $\mathrm{Ad}(\xi)$ induces a complementary polyhedron d [Beh95, Proposition 6.6], such that the semi/poly/stability conditions of ξ, $\mathrm{Ad}(\xi)$ and d are equivalent. Facets P of Φ correspond to parabolic reductions of ξ [Beh95, Proposition 6.2], and canonical reductions correspond to the unique **special facet**, characterized by going through $y(d) := \min(F)$ and $F(P)$ [Beh95, Lemma 3.11].

Complementary polyhedron example [Rot26, Example 2.2.4]

Let $\Phi := A_2$ with simple roots $\triangle = \{\alpha, \beta\}$, label the Weyl chamber containing the root $\gamma \in A_2$ by $\mathfrak{c}_\gamma$. Define $d(\mathfrak{c}_{-\beta}) = d(\mathfrak{c}_\alpha) = \check{\beta}$ and $d(\mathfrak{c}_{-\alpha-\beta}) = d(\mathfrak{c}_{-\alpha}) = \widetilde{\alpha+\beta}$, $d(\mathfrak{c}_{\alpha+\beta}) = \check{\beta}/2$, $d(\mathfrak{c}_\beta) = (\widetilde{\alpha+\beta})/2$, which has the trapezium convex hull F and special facet P dual to $\check{P}$ (see right).



This story works not only for principal bundles (so also vector bundles), but also for **Higgs bundles** [Wiß14], **parabolic bundles** [HS10], and **parahoric (Higgs) torsors** [Hei17; Rég25]. It would be great to hijack this to construct **Jordan-Hölder filtrations/reductions** for these. For this, I define **Jordan-Hölder (JH) facets**.

Jordan-Hölder facets [Rot26, Definition 2.5.1]

For a semistable complementary polyhedron $d : \mathfrak{W}_\Phi \to V^*$, a facet P is **Jordan-Hölder (JH)** if:

(JH1) $\mathrm{span}(\check{P}) \cap F(P) = \{0\}$.
(JH2) $\mathrm{span}(\check{P}) \cap \mathrm{relint}(F(P)) \neq \emptyset$ and $\mathrm{span}(\check{P}, F(P)) = V^*$.

By an induction proof, I have verified that JH facets exist.

Existence of Jordan-Hölder facets [Rot26, Theorem 2.5.6]

For a semistable complementary polyhedron $d : \mathfrak{W}_\Phi \to V^*$, a Jordan-Hölder facet d exists.

I perform induction on the rank of Φ. The only rank 1 root system is A_1 with two Weyl chambers, so F becomes an interval and it is easy to check. The inductive step requires thinking about how d interacts with projections to hyperplanes.

JH facets P give stable **Levi-complementary polyhedra** $d_P : \mathfrak{W}_{\Phi_P} \to \check{P}^\perp$ of d, by looking at the definition of stability and applying (JH2). The analog of uniqueness of associated graded $\mathrm{gr}(E)$ is more involved and requires an induction proof.

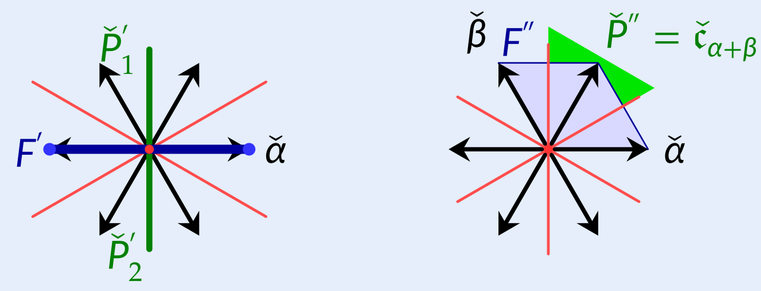
Uniqueness of Jordan-Hölder facets up to Levi [Rot26, Theorem 2.5.7]

For a semistable complementary polyhedron $d : \mathfrak{W}_\Phi \to V^*$, and JH facets P_1 and P_2, then:

(i) $\exists \tau \in \mathrm{Aut}(\Phi)$, such that $\tau(P_1) = \tau(P_2)$.
(ii) $d_{P_1} = d_{P_2} : \mathfrak{W}_{\Phi_{P_1}} = \mathfrak{W}_{\Phi_{P_2}} \to P_1^\perp = P_2^\perp$.

Examples of Jordan-Hölder facets [Rot26, Example 2.5.5]

Same setup as last example, we give two more complementary polyhedra: Let $d'(\mathfrak{c}_{-\beta}) = d'(\mathfrak{c}_\alpha) = d'(\mathfrak{c}_{\alpha+\beta}) = -\check{\alpha}$ and $d'(\mathfrak{c}_{-\alpha-\beta}) = d'(\mathfrak{c}_{-\alpha}) = d'(\mathfrak{c}_\beta) = \check{\alpha}$. Also let $d''(\mathfrak{c}_{-\beta}) = d''(\mathfrak{c}_\alpha) = \check{\beta}$, $d''(\mathfrak{c}_{-\alpha-\beta}) = \widetilde{\alpha+\beta}$, $d''(\mathfrak{c}_{-\alpha}) = d''(\mathfrak{c}_\beta) = \check{\alpha}$, and $d''(\mathfrak{c}_{\alpha+\beta}) = 0$. We have the convex hulls F' and F'' with JH facets:



For d' the τ in the prior theorem is flipping along the α-axis.

We translate these results to results on reductive group schemes.

Jordan-Hölder parabolics of reductive group schemes [Rot26, Theorem 3.2.3]

Let $\mathbf{G}$ be a reductive group scheme over X that is rationally split, i.e., $\mathbf{G}$ splits over $\eta := \mathrm{Spec}(K(X))$. For a torus $\mathbf{T}_\eta$ of $\mathbf{G}_\eta$, let $d : \mathfrak{W}_{\Phi(\mathbf{G}_\eta, \mathbf{T}_\eta)} \to V^*_{\mathbf{G}_\eta, \mathbf{T}_\eta}$ be a semistable complementary polyhedron, then there exists Jordan-Hölder parabolics $\mathbf{P}$ of $\mathbf{G}$ with respect to d, unique up to Levi.

Like the Harder-Narasimhan/canonical reduction case, d stores the stability of the moduli problem, its JH facets induce JH filtrations/reductions.

Examples of Jordan-Hölder facets inducing Jordan-Hölder filtrations

Let $E = L_1 \oplus F$ be the direct sum of a degree 1 line bundle L_1 and a rank 2 stable vector bundle F, which is the extension of $0 \to L_0 \to F \to L_2 \to 0$, $\deg(L_i) = i$. For $x \in X$, Serre vanishing gives $\mathrm{Ext}^1(L_2(-nx), L_0) = 0$ for $n \gg 0$, which implies $F \times_{L_2} L_2(-nx) \cong L_2(-nx) \oplus L_0$ so $L_2(-nx)$ embeds into F. Let $L' := L_2(-nx)^{sat}$ be the saturation, then for $\eta := \mathrm{Spec}(K(X))$ we have $E_\eta \cong (L_1)_\eta \oplus (L_0)_\eta \oplus (L')_\eta$. Using [Wiß14, 3.3.11 Remark.], the degrees of these bundles calculate the complementary polyhedron of $\mathrm{Ad}(E)$ to be d' from the last example. The JH filtrations:

$$0 \subset F \subset E \qquad\qquad 0 \subset L_1 \subset E$$

correspond to the JH facets of d'. For d'' the JH filtration is a full flag.

Jordan-Hölder filtrations of parahoric torsors [Rot26, Theorem 5.2.8]

Let $\underline{\chi}$ be an admissible stability parameter, and let ξ be a $\underline{\chi}$-semistable parahoric $\mathcal{G}$-torsor. $\exists$ JH reduction $s : X \to \xi/\mathcal{G}_\mathsf{P}$ to a parabolic subgroup $\mathcal{G}_\mathsf{P}$ of $\mathcal{G}$ such that:

(i) The reduction s is *admissible*, i.e., for every cocharacter $\boldsymbol{\lambda}_\mathfrak{v} : \mathbb{G}_{m,X} \to \mathrm{Ad}(s^*\xi)$ corresponding to a vertex $\mathfrak{v} \in \pi_0(t(\mathrm{Ad}(s^*\xi)))$, we have $n_{\underline{\chi}}(\mathrm{Ad}(s^*\xi), \boldsymbol{\lambda}_\mathfrak{v}) = 0$.
(ii) The extension to the Levi $(s^*\xi)(\mathcal{L}_\mathsf{P})$ is $\underline{\chi}|_{\mathcal{L}_\mathsf{P}}$-stable.

These reductions are unique up to Levi.

Theorem above works for Higgs torsors [Rot26, Theorem 5.3.6]. We then prove that **quasi-S-equivalence** from Zhang in [Zha24] is the same as our S-equivalence.

Jordan-Hölder filtrations of moduli stacks [Rot26, Theorem 5.2.11]

For parahoric $\mathcal{G}$-torsors, quasi-S-equivalence is the same as S-equivalence induced from [Rot26, Theorem 5.2.8].

[AHH23] Jarod Alper, Daniel Halpern-Leistner, and Jochen Heinloth. "Existence of moduli spaces for algebraic stacks". (2023).
[Alp13] Jarod Alper. "Good moduli spaces for Artin stacks". (2013).
[Beh95] Kai A. Behrend. "Semi-stability of reductive group schemes over curves". (1995).
[Hei17] Jochen Heinloth. "Hilbert-Mumford stability on algebraic stacks and applications to $\mathcal{G}$-bundles on curves". (2017).
[HS10] Jochen Heinloth and Alexander H. W. Schmitt. "The cohomology rings of moduli stacks of principal bundles over curves". (2010).
[Ram96] A. Ramanathan. "Moduli for principal bundles over algebraic curves: I and II". (1996).
[Rég25] Karim Réga. "On the moduli Space of parahoric Higgs bundles". (2025).
[Rot26] Emanuel Roth. "Jordan-Hölder theory for complementary polyhedra and moduli of parahoric Higgs torsors". (2026). arXiv: 2609.17231.
[Ses67] C. S. Seshadri. "Space of unitary vector bundles on a compact Riemann surface". (1967).
[SP] The Stacks project authors. "The Stacks project". (2026).
[Wiß14] Anna Wißdorf. "Stability and moduli of decorated principal bundles on projective schemes". (2014).
[Zha24] Xucheng Zhang. "S-Equivalence for algebraic stacks". (2024). arXiv: 2411.04053.